

LAPTOPS – MAINSTREAM

All-round performance minus the bulk and the hefty price tag

Mainstream laptops, as a category keeps in mind both, multimedia as well as gaming performance – delivering the best of both worlds, without burning a hole in your pocket. These laptops get you through your working hours and are perfect companions when it comes to entertainment and some casual gaming. Shaving off those extra kilograms as compared to the bulky gaming laptops, mainstream laptops this year seemed to be experimenting with their looks along with upgrading the hardware to the latest generation. The same can be said for the audio solutions as OEMs included speaker setups from leading audio houses like Dolby, B&O, and many more in their mainstream SKUs.

ZERO 1 WINNER

Lenovo Ideapad Y700

Laptops from Lenovo's Y-series have been dominating this category for the past two years in our Zero 1 awards and this year too, Lenovo seemed to be in no mood to pass this chance. The Lenovo Ideapad Y700 packs in an Intel Core i7-6700 HQ processor that is clocked at 2.6GHz along with the options of 8GB RAM or 16GB RAM. Upgrading from the last year's 8GB SSD hybrid storage, Lenovo has decided to go with a dual storage setup that includes a 128GB SSD and a 1TB HDD for this one. On the top you get a 15.6-inch Full HD IPS anti-glare display which is backed by the NVIDIA GeForce GTX 960M GPU with 4GB memory. The laptop promises a top-notch performance in handling day to day tasks along with cranking out about 30 FPS in most of the games without breaking a sweat. The gorgeous display along with the dual JBL speakers and a subwoofer setup is truly a treat for anyone using this laptop. Not only powerful inside, the laptop also boasts a different design, making it stand out amongst the rest. With an average battery life, the Ideapad Y700 manages to tick all the right boxes, scoring a 75 out of 100, making it the best performing mainstream laptop.

RUNNER UP

Dell Inspiron 15 7559

Fighting hard, the Dell Inspiron 15 7559 packs in equally beefy hardware as the Ideapad Y700



Lenovo Ideapad Y700

Price: ₹91,990



Dell Inspiron 15 7559

Price: ₹1,14,390
(Starts from ₹81,690)



HP Pavilion 15-au620tx

Price: ₹59,290

with the 6th generation i7-6700 HQ processor, 16GB RAM, a combination of 128GB SSD + 1TB HDD along with the NVIDIA GeForce GTX 960M and a mesmerising 15.6-inch UHD touch-screen display that boasts a resolution of 3840 x 2160. Moreover, the Inspiron 15 7559, too, stands out in its clean yet eye-catching design and is economical on the weight as well. With a difference of mere 200 points on the PCMark 8 Creative benchmark, this laptop does give a tough competition to the Ideapad Y700, but falls just a little short, when it comes to handling games. Don't get us wrong here, casual gaming on this laptop is equally entertaining, however, you might have to compromise on display resolution in order to keep your FPS count upto the mark. The Inspiron 15 7559 is best at maintaining its cool even under heavy loads and comes with a decent battery life. The dual speaker plus a subwoofer combined with Waves MaxxAudio Pro is a good addition, however, the difference is barely noticeable. Make no mistake, the Dell Inspiron 15 7559 is a great package for multimedia users with casual gaming, trailing just behind the Ideapad Y700.

BEST BUY

HP Pavilion 15-au620tx

The HP Pavilion 15-au620tx sports a 7th generation Intel Core i5 processor along with 8GB RAM, 1TB HDD along with 2GB NVIDIA GeForce 940MX dedicated GPU. The laptop offers a latest generation processor along with fairly decent day-to-day performance, and all of it under ₹60,000. Quite a steal we must say! 